

Irregular word spellings

SOME SPELLINGS DON'T FOLLOW ANY RULES.

The only way to remember irregular spellings is to learn them. However, there are ways to do this that are more fun than just staring at the words.

SEE ALSO

◀ 134–135 Syllables

◀ 138–139 Understanding English irregularities

◀ 156–157 The “i before e except after c” rule

Weird words

Some words are difficult to spell because they are not spelled like they sound. For example, *said* rhymes with *led* and *fed* but is spelled very differently. Other irregular spellings are tricky because they go against common rules. For example, the word *foreign* does not follow the “i before e except after c” rule.



- One way to learn a spelling is to put up **reminders** everywhere. Write the **troublesome word** in **large letters**, and then put it on the **wall** or anywhere around the house where it will be seen **throughout the day**.

A

- accidentally
- again
- archaeology
- asthma

B

- beautiful
- because
- beginning
- beige

C

- circuit
- conscience
- cough
- country

D

- definitely
- disappear
- disguise
- does

E

- Egypt
- embarrassed
- enough
- especially

F

- fluorescent
- foreign
- forty

G

- geography
- graffiti
- guarantee

H

- height

I

- jeopardy
- jewel

J

- jeopardy
- jewel

K

- knee

L

- lawyer
- leopard
- liaison

M

- mischievous

N

- nuisance

O

- ocean

P

- particularly
- people
- pharaoh
- psychology

R

- raspberry
- restaurant
- rhythm
- rough

S

- school
- soldier
- straight
- surprise

T

- Tuesday
- tomorrow
- tongue
- twelfth

V

- vicious

W

- weird

Y

- yacht
- young